

ANNOTATION GUIDELINES - SCIENTIFIC PAPER SECTIONS

Dataset: scientific papers from a vast range of fields—from biology and computer science to philosophy and sociology.

Task: assign the most appropriate section label to each header within a scientific paper. A single logical section (like 'Methods') might be broken into several smaller headers (e.g., 'Study Design', then 'Participants', then 'Statistical Analysis'). Your job is to **label each of these individual headers**.

Important note about the data: the headers and text sections you will see have been pre-extracted by an automated algorithm from the original scientific papers. This algorithm identifies section headers and associated text from PDFs and other document formats. While some headers may appear obvious or already well-labeled (e.g., sections clearly titled 'Introduction' or 'Methods'), the extraction process also includes formatting errors like sections split awkwardly or related content being combined.

- When headers seem straightforward, your confirmation ensures data quality.
- For papers or headers that are not as clear, you have to understand the unconventional organization or field-specific terminology and label each header with the appropriate section label (more details below).

Keep these guidelines open and consult them often: you should consult this document regularly, especially when encountering unfamiliar section types or ambiguous cases. The guidelines are also accessible via the button at the top of each annotation page.

Annotation Workflow 📝

1. **Familiarize yourself:** Read through the **entire sequence of headers** for that paper (left panel) once to understand its overall structure, topic, and flow (e.g., Is it an experimental paper? A theoretical one? A review?).
 - a. Context is everything. A section called "Our Model" that comes after "Introduction" and before "Experiments" is almost certainly methods.
 - b. **If the paper is not in English**, mark the checkbox at the bottom left of the page ("Other Language") and go to the next one. You do not need to annotate those.
2. **Annotate sequentially:** Go to the beginning of the list. For each header, assign one of the section labels. Use your understanding of the entire paper's structure to resolve any ambiguities. Continue until every header in the paper is labeled.
 - a. **Words vs paragraphs:** even if a row is a single word, you should still assign a label to it. Generally the text related to that comes in the following rows.

- b. **Confusing papers:** If the structure is too different for you or you're very unsure about how to label a specific paper, you can mark the checkbox "Annotator Unsure" at the bottom left of the page. Still try to label any sections that you can, though.
3. **Proceed to the next Paper.**

Important: Not all papers will have all sections! Most will only have a subset. A computer science paper might not have a separate **lit_review**, and a philosophy paper won't have experimental **results**. Your task is to label what's there, not what "should" be there.

Note: The "Other Language" and "Annotator Unsure" checkboxes are only available during the main annotation task, not during the paper for the screening study.

Label Definitions

Most common:

- **introduction:** Sets the stage, typically introducing the topic, explaining why it's important (motivation), stating the core problem or research questions, and may provide an overview of the paper's structure.
- **lit_review:** Discusses previous work and the state-of-the-art, placing the current research within the existing academic conversation.
 - It is also the main body of papers that only review existing literature without presenting new findings.
- **methods:** *How* the research was conducted (e.g., study design, data, algorithms, experimental setup).
- **results:** Findings and data.
- **discussion:** Interprets the results, discusses implications, and limitations.
- **conclusion:** Summarizes the paper, provides concluding remarks, and often discusses future work.

Field-specific:

- **development:** The core argumentative or theoretical part of a paper that isn't presenting empirical methods or results. Common in fields like philosophy, theoretical math, or law.
- **case_report:** In Medicine papers, a narrative of a patient case or group of related cases. Often includes patient profiles, unique events, or specific interventions/treatments and their outcomes.

Only use if really needed:

- **something_else:** Other administrative sections that do not fit in any of the other labels.
- **ambiguous:** Use this label **only as a last resort** if it's impossible to determine the section's purpose from the given text and context.